

This problem presents a shortest path challenge with a unique cost function based on the cube of the difference in busyness values between junctions. The core complexity arises from the mathematical nature of the cost calculation: when traveling from junction u to junction v , the cost is defined as $(\text{busyness}[v] - \text{busyness}[u])^3$. This cubic function creates a challenging scenario because it can produce negative edge weights when the destination junction is less busy than the source junction, and these negative weights can potentially form negative cycles in the graph. The problem requires finding the minimum total cost (referred to as "earning" from the city authority's perspective) from junction 1 to various query junctions, with the additional constraint that any total cost less than 3 units should be reported as '?'.

The solution demands careful handling of negative cycles and unreachable nodes. When a negative cycle exists along a path from the source to a destination junction, the total cost can be made arbitrarily small by repeatedly traversing the cycle, making the minimum cost effectively undefined or negative infinity. Similarly, if the computed minimum cost is less than 3, regardless of cycles, the output should be '?'. This necessitates using the Bellman-Ford algorithm, which can detect negative cycles reachable from the source node. The implementation must not only compute shortest paths but also propagate the negative cycle influence to all affected nodes, ensuring that any query junction reachable through a negative cycle is correctly identified and marked with '?' in the output.

Steps:

1. Read Input

- Read number of junctions
- Read busyness values for each junction
- Read number of roads
- Store each road as directed edge with weight = $(\text{busyness}[\text{destination}] - \text{busyness}[\text{source}])^3$
- Read number of queries and query junctions

2. Initialize Arrays

- Create distance array with large values

- Set distance of junction 1 to 0
- Create array to mark nodes affected by negative cycles
- 3. **Run Bellman-Ford Algorithm**
 - Repeat n-1 times:
 - For each edge ($u \rightarrow v$):
 - If we can get a shorter path to v through u, update distance[v]
- 4. **Check for Negative Cycles**
 - Do one more pass through all edges
 - If any distance can still be improved, mark that node as in negative cycle
 - Use BFS/DFS to mark all nodes reachable from cycle nodes
- 5. **Answer Queries**
 - For each query junction:
 - If unreachable OR in negative cycle OR distance < 3: print "?"
 - Else: print the distance
- 6. **Output Results**
 - Print "Set #" with case number
 - Print each query result on separate line

Input:

5 6 7 8 9 10

6

1 2

2 3

3 4

1 5

5 4

4 5

2

4

5

Execution:

Step 1: Read Input

$n = 5$

busyness array: index 1=6, index 2=7, index 3=8, index 4=9, index 5=10

$r = 6$ roads

Compute edge weights:

$1 \rightarrow 2: (7-6)^3 = 1$

$2 \rightarrow 3: (8-7)^3 = 1$

$3 \rightarrow 4: (9-8)^3 = 1$

$1 \rightarrow 5: (10-6)^3 = 64$

$5 \rightarrow 4: (9-10)^3 = -1$

$4 \rightarrow 5: (10-9)^3 = 1$

$q = 2$ queries: 4 and 5

Step 2: Initialize Arrays

dist = [inf, 0, inf, inf, inf] for nodes 1-5

inCycle = all false

visited = all false

Step 3: Run Bellman-Ford (4 iterations)

Iteration 1:

Process edge $1 \rightarrow 2$: $0+1=1 < \text{inf} \rightarrow \text{update dist}[2]=1$

Process edge $2 \rightarrow 3$: $1+1=2 < \text{inf} \rightarrow \text{update dist}[3]=2$

Process edge $3 \rightarrow 4$: $2+1=3 < \text{inf} \rightarrow \text{update dist}[4]=3$

Process edge $1 \rightarrow 5$: $0+64=64 < \text{inf} \rightarrow \text{update dist}[5]=64$

Process edge $5 \rightarrow 4$: $64+(-1)=63 > 3 \rightarrow \text{no update}$

Process edge $4 \rightarrow 5$: $3+1=4 < 64 \rightarrow \text{update dist}[5]=4$

Iteration 2:

All edges checked, no improvements found

Iterations 3-4:

No changes

Current distances: dist[1]=0, dist[2]=1, dist[3]=2, dist[4]=3, dist[5]=4

Step 4: Detect Negative Cycles

Run Bellman-Ford again to check for cycles
All edges processed, no distance improvements
inCycle array remains all false
No BFS propagation needed since no cycles detected

Step 5: Process Queries

Query for node 4: $\text{dist}[4]=3$, not inf, not in cycle, $\geq 3 \rightarrow$ output 3
Query for node 5: $\text{dist}[5]=4$, not inf, not in cycle, $\geq 3 \rightarrow$ output 4

Output:

Set #1

3

4

Pseudocode:

READ n

READ busyness[1..n]

READ r roads, store edges with weight = $(\text{busyness}[v] - \text{busyness}[u])^3$

READ q queries

$\text{dist}[1..n] = \text{INF}$, $\text{dist}[1] = 0$

REPEAT n-1 times:

FOR each edge (u,v,w):

IF $\text{dist}[u] + w < \text{dist}[v]$:

$\text{dist}[v] = \text{dist}[u] + w$

$\text{inCycle}[1..n] = \text{false}$

REPEAT n-1 times:

FOR each edge (u,v,w):

IF $\text{dist}[u] + w < \text{dist}[v]$:

inCycle[v] = true

Propagate to all reachable nodes

FOR each query:

IF $\text{dist}[\text{query}] < 3$ OR unreachable OR inCycle: PRINT "?"

ELSE: PRINT $\text{dist}[\text{query}]$